Monitoring for Failed Jobs That Stop Retrying

Suppose our payments service deprecated the API call being used, and it now always returns an HTTP 503. That might not be how *you'd* handle API deprecation, but you can't control the payment processors of the world. In this case, what you've been treating as a transient error is now a permanent one. Luckily, you know how to handle permanent errors: monitor them. Unluckily, you just spent the last section disabling notifications about this particular error.

Sidekiq provides a solution called the *dead set*. The dead set is a set of jobs that have been retried too many times and have been set aside, never to be retried again. The default setting for `max_retries` results in a job being moved to the dead set after about 20 days. When that happens, you can use the Web UI to retry the job, as long as you know to look there.

To ensure you are notified when a job moves to the dead set, Sidekiq allows the configuration of a `death handler`. This works much like error handlers, in that you provide a `Proc` that will be called. Configure this using the `death_handlers` attribute on the Sidekiq server's `config`:

snapshots/2-2/sidekiq-book/config/initializers/sidekiq.rb

```
Sidekiq.configure_server do |config|
  config.death_handlers << ->(job,exception) {
    ErrorCatcherServiceWrapper.new.notify(
      "#{job['class']} won't be retried: #{exception.message}"
    )
  }
  config.error_handlers << ->(exception,context_hash) {
    ErrorCatcherServiceWrapper.new.notify(exception)
  }
```

To see this in action without waiting twenty days, you can temporarily change the Sidekiq configuration to only retry jobs once before moving them to the dead set. Do this by adding `max_retries` to `config/sidekiq.yml`: